STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-5400
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **11/14/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT REQUEST FOR RECOGNITION	CROSS REFERENCE			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for submission, review, and issuance of formal recognition.

II. Policy:

Sarpy County Sheriff's Office employees often perform acts beyond the scope of their normal duties. An employee, division, shift, unit, and/or team may receive formal recognition when this occurs. To maintain consistency in awarding recognitions, a review of all requests shall be conducted.

III. Procedures:

A. Levels of Recognition: The following levels of recognition are established for employees of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office. Recognition is listed in order of descending level of achievement.

Recognition may be awarded for, but is not limited to, the following:

1. **Medal of Honor:** This is the Sheriff's Office highest award and is awarded to employees who performed esteemed acts of bravery and courage to save another human life or to prevent major property destruction. The actions of the employee may have caused great bodily injury or death to himself/herself.

2. **Lifesaving Medal:** This award is for an employee whose direct actions saved another human life. The victim survived the incident because of the employee's decisiveness (e.g., rescue from a fire, drowning, or CPR).

3. **Medal of Valor:** This award is for an employee who performs a dangerous and/or distinguished act of conspicuous bravery or heroism above and

beyond the performance that is normally expected. The employee's actions may have placed himself or herself in danger of injury, resulted in injury to the acting employee or prevented or minimized injury to another, but may not have been life threatening.

4. Sheriff's Office Commendation:

a) Worked on an assignment, project, or case in which the employee far exceeded performance standards.

b) Sustained job performance that far exceeds standards.

c) Provided a crucial service to the Sheriff's Office, the public or an individual.

5. Sheriff's Office Community Service Award: This award is for an employee who has provided considerable community service or who has worked in a capacity outside of his or her assigned duties at the Sheriff's Office (e.g., fundraiser for a Sheriff's Office employee). This may be awarded to an employee who has volunteered his or her time to enhance the community or provided a service to a citizen(s) or an established non-profit organization.

6. Commander's Letter of Recognition:

a) Worked on an assignment, project, or case in which the employee exceeded performance standards.

b) Sustained job performance that exceeds standards.

c) Detected a crime and/or apprehended a criminal(s) through effort, initiative, and/or ingenuity that was beyond normal duties.

d) Identified and researched an issue that led to a new policy or procedure, or a significant revision of such.

B. Lifesaving Medals, Commendations, and Division Commander's Letters of Recognition may be presented to individual employees, shifts, units and/or teams.

C. Sheriff's Office Civilian Recognition Award: This award is for a civilian who has assisted the Sheriff's Office in its operations, function or in any aspect which makes recognition appropriate. This award may also be given to an individual who assists employees of the Sheriff's Office in their community efforts.

D. Requests for Recognition:

1. Any employee may submit a Request for Recognition form for another employee or a civilian.

2. The employee submitting the request shall recommend a specific level of recognition based upon the descriptions included in this policy. Requests shall be made for a single level of recognition for each submission.

3. All requests for recognition shall be submitted on an electronic Request for Recognition form. The form shall be sent electronically to the division commander of the employee for whom recognition was requested and the Sheriff's Office Recognition Review Board (Sheriff Recognition).

4. For a Commander's Letter of Recognition, the request form shall be forwarded only to the Assistant Administrative Commander and the Chief Deputy.

E. Sheriff's Office Recognition Review Board: The Chief Deputy shall appoint a Recognition Review Board, which shall consist of an administrative commander, one other Sheriff's Office commander and two Sheriff's Office employees.

F. Review of Requests for Recognition: The review of requests shall be based upon the level of recognition requested. The established process shall ensure a fair and objective review and to ensure consistency in recognitions awarded.

1. **Commander's Letter of Recognition Request:** If the request is approved by the Chief Deputy, a Division Commander shall write the Letter of Recognition.

2. **All Other Requests:** The Assistant Administrative Commander shall maintain all pending requests until the Review Board convenes. The Assistant Administrative Commander shall complete a Recognition Request Flow Sheet for each request. The board shall make a recommendation to the Sheriff and the Chief Deputy for all pending requests. The Chief Deputy shall write a Sheriff's Office letter for each approved request.

G. Issuance of Recognition:

1. The Chief Deputy shall have the final decision on a Commander's Letter of Recognition. The Sheriff shall have the final decision on all other levels of recognition. If a request for recognition is denied, a written reply shall be sent to the employee requesting the recognition.

2. If a request for recognition is approved, the request and the documentation shall be returned to the Assistant Administrative Commander. The Chief Deputy shall ensure the recipient receives a plaque, if applicable, and a letter.

3. All original letters shall be placed in the recipient's personnel file.

4. All requests for recognition shall be completed (approved or denied) within forty-five (45) days of the date of submission.